



Ray of Hope

WITH INDIAN-ORIGIN RISHI SUNAK taking charge as the UK Prime Minister, hopes of more favourable deals from London have surged. An FTA between the two nations, that would be advantageous to Indian exporters, has been in the works, and is now expected to get further impetus. India is also pushing for relaxation in visa rules for Indians.

—ARNAB DUTTA

THE AMERICAN DREAM

Lupin CEO Vinita Gupta is focussed on strengthening the company's respiratory franchise in the US. Lupin aims to expand its portfolio of inhalation products, and as part of the plan, it recently signed a pact to acquire the rights to two inhalation medicines—Brovana Inhalation Solution and Xopenex HFA Inhalation Aerosol—from Sunovion Pharmaceuticals for \$75 million. Gupta says the addition of these two brands enhances Lupin's position in the segment. All eyes are on the US market now.

—NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA

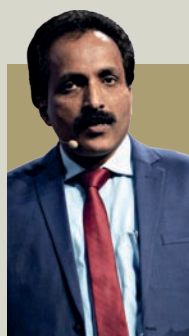


BHUJIA KING

SHIV RATAN AGARWAL has come a long way since launching the Bikaji brand in 1993 with the company now listing on the bourses. Given his stature in the savouries and snacks segment, which is estimated to be valued at ₹72,800 crore, he is fondly called 'guruji' by his peers. In nearly 30 years, he ensured that the brand—named after Bika Rao, the founder of Bikaner—became the largest manufacturer of Bikaneri *bhujia*. For Agarwal, snacking is serious business.

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR

Rocket Man



India's dream of launching its first human spaceflight may become a reality towards the end of 2024. **Sreedhar Panicker Somanath**, Chairperson of ISRO and Secretary of the Department of Space, has said that the country is "well on its course". India's space sector is set for some high flying!

—MANISH PANT



THE HARBINGER

Zerodha Co-founder & CEO Nithin Kamath has some advice for millennials and the GenZ. With the retirement age declining and life expectancy increasing, the retirement crisis, according to him, could be the biggest problem for most countries 25 years from now. In a social media post, he has advised people to plan accordingly—start saving early and diversify across fixed deposits/G-secs and start SIPs of index funds/ETFs.

—RAHUL OBEROI

CHARGING AHEAD

Maruti Suzuki is set to launch its first electric car in 2025. Chairman **R.C. Bhargava** doesn't feel that his company is late to the party, even as electric cars from his competitors have already hit Indian roads. "I don't think we started late. We started in a systematic manner by localising more," he said. In September, electric car sales in India grew 172 per cent YoY. It seems the EV battle is set to intensify further.

—PRERNA LIDHOO



Falling Fortunes

SINCE THE beginning of 2022, Amazon Founder **Jeff Bezos** has lost over \$77 billion of his wealth, with more than \$7 billion wiped out in a single day after the online retail giant reported weak Q3 earnings. On November 1, Amazon's market cap dropped below \$1 trillion for the first time since April 2020, amid a continuing sell-off in the stock. Bezos, who earns a majority of his wealth from his shareholding in Amazon, however, remains the world's fourth-richest person with a net worth of \$115 billion as of November 3.

—SOHINI MITTER



RISHI SUNAK PHOTO BY ANI; VINITA GUPTA PHOTO BY RACHIT GOSWAMI; R.C. BHARGAVA PHOTO BY BANDEEP SINGH